

# Sevinj Safarova

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## SUMMARY

- Experienced DevOps Engineer with 8 years in IT and a strong focus on cloud infrastructure, CI/CD pipelines, automation, and release engineering across AWS, GCP, Azure, and on-premises environments. Skilled in implementing highly available, scalable, and secure systems with an emphasis on optimizing deployment and operations.
- Certified AWS Solution Architect and Certified Scrum Master, with extensive experience building and supporting cloud-based solutions in Development, Deployment, Delivery, Operations, and Monitoring.
- Expert in AWS cloud services including EC2, S3, RDS, VPC, Route 53, CloudWatch, and IAM, with hands-on expertise in automating infrastructure provisioning and monitoring using tools such as Terraform, Ansible, and CloudFormation.
- Proficient in Infrastructure as Code (IaC) using Terraform, Ansible, and CloudFormation for seamless infrastructure deployment and management, ensuring optimal system performance and cost-efficiency.
- Experienced with CI/CD pipeline automation using Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, and Azure DevOps, enhancing software delivery speed and reducing manual intervention.
- Strong background in configuration management with Ansible, Chef, and Puppet to automate and maintain system consistency across distributed environments.
- Hands-on experience with containerization and orchestration technologies such as Docker, Kubernetes, and OpenShift to scale and manage microservices effectively in cloud and on-prem environments.
- Proficient in scripting and automation using Python, Bash, and PowerShell, streamlining deployment workflows, infrastructure provisioning, and monitoring.
- Skilled in version control systems including Git and GitHub, implementing best practices to manage code versions and integrate seamlessly with CI/CD workflows.
- Expertise in monitoring and logging tools like Grafana, Prometheus, AWS CloudWatch, and Splunk, ensuring real-time system observability and proactive incident response.
- Solid knowledge in security and compliance, including IAM, SSL/TLS, encryption, vulnerability scanning, and GDPR to enhance system security and ensure adherence to industry standards.
- Proficient in managing Helm charts for Kubernetes applications, ensuring consistent and automated deployments with version control and rollback capabilities.
- Proven ability to collaborate with cross-functional teams to drive DevOps best practices, continuous integration, and process automation across engineering and operations.

## SKILLS

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|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Cloud Platforms</b>                            | AWS (CloudFormation, CloudWatch, VPC, EC2, S3, Glacier, ECS, Elastic Beanstalk, Snowball, DynamoDB, RDS, Redshift, Direct Connect, Route 53, IAM, Lambda, AWS IoT, SNS, SES, SWF, Elasticsearch, CodeCommit)                                                                                 |
| <b>CI/CD Tools</b>                                | Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, Azure DevOps, AWS CodePipeline, ArgoCD, Spinnaker, Bamboo, TeamCity                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Containerization</b>                           | Docker, Kubernetes (EKS, AKS, GKE), Helm, OpenShift                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Monitoring &amp; Logging</b>                   | Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana), AWS CloudWatch, Splunk, Datadog, New Relic, Nagios, Zabbix, Spectrum                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Programming/Scripting</b>                      | Python, Java, Groovy, Ruby, Shell (Bash, PowerShell), Perl                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Networking &amp; Configuration Management</b>  | TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, FTP, SSH, NFS, VPN, Load Balancers (ALB, NLB, HAProxy, Nginx), NetBox                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Security &amp; Build Tools</b>                 | IAM, RBAC, Artifactory, SonarQube, SSL/TLS, HashiCorp Vault, Maven, Ant, Nexus,                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Database Systems</b>                           | MySQL, PostgreSQL, AWS Redshift, AWS RDS, DynamoDB, MongoDB, Elasticsearch                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Version Control &amp; Infrastructure Tools</b> | GitHub, GitLab, Git, Bitbucket, Terraform, Packer, Vagrant, AWS CloudFormation, SVN, CVS, Beanstalk, Terraform, ARM Templates                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Other Tools</b>                                | JIRA, Scoro, Nexus, Apache HTTP Server, WebSphere, WPF, Apache Tomcat, Nginx, Silverlight 4, Selenium, JUnit, JMeter, Django & Flask, Agile, HPE OneView, VMWare, Vcenter, Vsphere, Guacamole, IAP, Selenium, Cucumber, Maven, Sequana servers, Superdomes, TopRackSwitches, BrocadeSwitches |

## **PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE**

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### **DISCOVER FINANCIAL GROUP - CHICAGO, IL**

**March 2025 – Present**

#### **Site Reliability Engineer**

- Built and maintained scalable cloud infrastructure using Kubernetes and Terraform, automating provisioning and ensuring high availability across environments.
- Developed and optimized observability solutions with Prometheus, Grafana, and ELK Stack, improving system monitoring and proactive alerting.
- Implemented and automated CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions and Jenkins, reducing deployment time and increasing software delivery efficiency.
- Conducted performance tuning and capacity planning, reducing downtime and improving system reliability through predictive scaling strategies.
- Established SLOs, SLIs, and SLAs to measure service performance, aligning with business objectives and ensuring compliance with uptime requirements.
- Performed security audits and compliance checks, integrating IAM, encryption, and vulnerability assessments to meet SOC 2, PCI DSS, and ISO 27001 standards.
- Led incident response and root cause analysis (RCA) for critical outages, implementing long-term solutions to enhance system stability and prevent future failures.
- Diagnosed and resolved complex infrastructure issues, optimizing system performance and ensuring seamless operations for enterprise workloads.
- Optimized cost management and resource utilization by implementing auto-scaling policies and rightsizing cloud instances, reducing operational expenses.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to design and implement fault-tolerant architectures, ensuring system resilience and minimizing downtime.

### **EVIDEN - CHICAGO, IL**

**May 2022 – Mar 2025**

#### **DevOps Engineer**

- Engineered and managed Google Cloud Bare Metal Solution, enabling enterprises to run high-performance workloads. Automated infrastructure operations, reducing manual interventions and enhancing system reliability.
- Automated operational tasks using Ansible and Apache Airflow, improving workflow efficiency and reducing downtime. Designed and maintained Ansible playbooks to standardize configurations and optimize infrastructure management.
- Deployed and managed microservices on Kubernetes, ensuring containerized applications remained scalable, resilient, and easily maintained. Integrated CI/CD pipelines to automate deployments and improve software delivery.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and security audits, mitigating risks and ensuring compliance with security frameworks such as SOC 2, ISMAP, and PCI DSS. Automated compliance evidence collection to improve audit efficiency.
- Developed and maintained Prometheus exporters and Grafana dashboards, enabling real-time monitoring of system performance. Implemented proactive alerting mechanisms to enhance observability and reduce incident response times.
- Provisioned infrastructure as code (IaC) components using Ansible-based CI/CD pipelines, Terraform, and CloudFormation to ensure automated infrastructure management.
- Led incident response, troubleshooting, and root cause analysis (RCA) for system failures and performance issues, implementing long-term solutions to enhance stability and prevent recurrence.
- Developed and enhanced Baseboard Management Controller (BMC) features, optimizing performance and porting functionality to new hardware. Debugged and resolved complex issues reported by customers and internal engineering teams.
- Managed version control and CI/CD pipelines using Git, Jenkins, and GitHub Actions, ensuring smooth code integrations and deployments. Implemented best practices in branching strategies, accelerating release cycles by 20%.
- Designed JSON-based automation scripts for server provisioning, deprovisioning, and storage management (LUNs), significantly reducing manual interventions and improving provisioning efficiency by 50%.
- Improved operational efficiency by 30% by streamlining infrastructure processes, including provisioning, deprovisioning, server initialization, re-imaging, and data restoration. Standardized workflows to enhance reliability and reduce human errors.
- Provided 24/7 on-call support for mission-critical applications and infrastructure, ensuring rapid resolution of high-priority incidents. Diagnosed and addressed hardware and software failures to maintain high availability.

**AETNA - CHICAGO, IL****June 2019 – May 2022****Devops engineer**

- Assisted application teams in setting up environments, building, and deploying applications while ensuring proper architecture, security standards, and CI/CD best practices using Terraform.
- Utilized AWS services such as EC2, RDS (MySQL), S3, Route 53, and CloudWatch to optimize infrastructure, improve scalability, and enhance monitoring capabilities.
- Containerized applications with Docker and deployed them on Amazon ECS with Auto Scaling, ensuring high availability and automated scaling.
- Configured and automated CI/CD pipelines using AWS CodeDeploy and CodePipeline, streamlining software delivery and reducing deployment errors.
- Implemented AWS security best practices, including IAM policies, security groups, and AWS WAF, enhancing overall system security and compliance.
- Developed end-to-end CI/CD pipelines in Jenkins, automating code retrieval, compilation, testing, and deployment.
- Managed Git repositories, code merging, and production deployments, ensuring smooth version control and collaboration.
- Built and managed AWS infrastructure using Terraform and CloudFormation, automating resource provisioning and scaling.
- Managed version control and CI/CD pipelines using Git, Jenkins, and GitHub Actions, ensuring smooth code integrations and deployments. Implemented best practices in branching strategies, accelerating release cycles by 20%.
- Implemented Kubernetes clusters, creating and managing pods, ReplicaSets, services, and deployments, enhancing application scalability and resilience.
- Optimized high-availability applications across AWS availability zones, ensuring minimized downtime and enhanced failover capabilities.
- Designed secure AWS environments with security groups, network ACLs, NAT instances, and Route Tables, ensuring robust security and compliance across cloud infrastructure.

**ACCQUOTE – CHICAGO, IL****Sep 2017 – June 2019****DevOps Engineer**

- Created and managed EC2 instances of different types (spot, on-demand, reserved) to optimize cost and performance for diverse workloads..
- Configured and managed VPC with public and private subnets, setting up Internet Gateway, NAT Gateway, and Bastion Host for secure access to private subnets.
- Established peering connections between VPCs to enable seamless communication and data exchange across multiple cloud environments.
- Managed IAM (users, groups, roles, and policies) to enforce security controls and best practices for access management across AWS resources.
- Developed and maintained automation test scripts using Selenium WebDriver with Java and Maven, enabling automated testing for web applications.
- Performed functional and regression testing using Selenium with data-driven and keyword-driven frameworks, ensuring robust and repeatable test coverage..
- Conducted cross-browser testing and parallel testing on Chrome, Firefox, and Safari, leveraging Maven for optimized execution..
- Integrated Jenkins with GitHub and Maven for CI/CD pipelines, automating the build, test, and deployment process for faster, more reliable releases.
- Managed AWS resources like S3, Glacier, and EBS, optimizing storage solutions for backup, recovery, and data archiving.
- Implemented and optimized monitoring solutions using AWS CloudWatch for real-time resource and application performance tracking.
- Utilized Jira for logging, tracking, and resolving technical issues, ensuring efficient issue resolution and project management across teams.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams using Jira, Confluence, and ServiceNow, improving DevOps workflows, enhancing project visibility, and ensuring timely delivery of applications.

## **CERTIFICATIONS**

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- **Certified SCRUM Master (CSM) - SCRUM Alliance**
- **AWS Solution Architect-Associate -Amazon Web Services**
- **Eviden LCS2 Revolutionize Coding**
- **Fireside chat: Impact of Gen AI**
- **Eviden LCS2-Prompt Engineering**
- **Atos Generative AI**
- **Generative AI: Generative AI and Its Impact to Everyday Business**
- **Eviden LCS2 MaxEfficiency GenAI**
- **Eviden LCS2 Unlocking Gen AI**
- **Eviden LCS2 Amazon Q**
- **Eviden LCS2 Gen AI in Azure**
- **Eviden LCS2 Automation Testing**
- **Eviden LCS2 SD & Intelligent Bots**
- **MongoDB Atlas: An Introduction**